HOW TO USE GUIDE · VERSION 1.0

DG-Dock

A fast, good-looking dock for Windows 11 — your apps, folders, search, music and system tray in one place at the bottom of the screen.

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Made by Dippy_drippy

For Windows 11

01 · OVERVIEW

All the features at a glance

Everything DG-Dock can do, in one page. Each feature has its own section later in this guide.

Pill-style dock

Rounded pills for apps, folders and widgets. Follows Windows' light or dark mode and the taskbar's colour.

Smooth magnification

Icons grow as you point at them, with labels and click bounce. Runs at your screen's refresh rate.

Window previews

Point at an open app to see live previews of its windows. Close any of them from the card.

Drag and drop

Drag apps on to add them, drag along to reorder, drag off to remove with a puff of smoke.

Pages

Up to two pages of apps with page dots. Scroll over the apps to flip; the dock resizes to fit.

Open-apps pill

Apps you haven't pinned slide out into their own pill, and melt back when you close them.

Folder cards

Point at a folder for a grid of its contents. Open folders inside the card and scroll through.

Search

Find apps, settings and files, do quick sums and search the web — from the Start button or **Alt + Space**.

Clock widget

Time and date. Click for Windows' calendar and notifications.

Battery, Wi-Fi and brightness

Battery ring with Wi-Fi dots. Scroll on it to change screen brightness; click for Quick Settings.

Now playing

Cover art and a live sound wave that appears only while music plays. Scroll on it for volume.

System tray

Your system-tray apps in one tile at the end of the dock, so you never need the taskbar.

Show desktop

A slim bar at the very end. Click to see the desktop, click again to bring windows back.

Your own icons

Change any icon — apps, folders, files in folder cards and tray apps — or use an Android icon pack.

Settings panel

A Windows 11-style panel: sliders you can type into, switches, Edit Dock and an animation-speed control.

Hiding and space

Auto-hide, smart hide, keep space for the dock, hide the Windows taskbar and hide in full-screen apps.

Any side of the screen

Put the dock at the bottom, left or right, on your main display or the one your mouse is on.

One-file installer

Installs just for you — no administrator password — and removes cleanly from Settings › Apps.

Installing and removing

DG-Dock comes as one file, **DG-Dock-Setup-1.0.0.exe**. It installs just for your Windows account, so it never asks for an administrator password.

1

Open the file

Double-click **DG-Dock-Setup-1.0.0.exe** in your Downloads.

2

If Windows warns you

On “Windows protected your PC”, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.

3

Accept and install

Tick **I accept the DG-Dock Licence**, pick your options, then **Install**.

4

Open DG-Dock

The dock slides up from the bottom of the screen. That's it.

Why the blue warning? Windows shows it for new programs that aren't yet digitally signed or widely downloaded. It goes away as more people use DG-Dock. The installer doesn't change any security settings on your PC.

What gets installed

ITEM	WHERE
The app	Your own AppData folder: `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\DG-Dock`
Shortcuts	Start menu, and on the desktop if you ticked it
Your settings and icon packs	`%APPDATA%\DG-Dock` — kept if you reinstall
Licence	LICENSE.txt and THIRD-PARTY-NOTICES.txt in the app folder, and in Settings › About

Updating

Run the newer setup file. It shows **Update** instead of Install, closes the running dock, swaps in the new version and starts it again. Your dock, settings and icons stay exactly as they were.

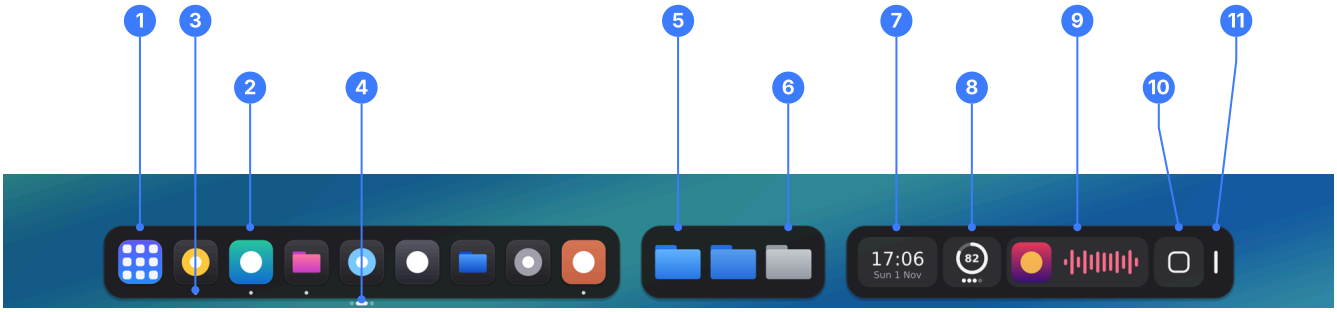
Removing DG-Dock

- Open **Settings › Apps › Installed apps**, find **DG-Dock**, choose **Uninstall**.
- The Windows taskbar is put back automatically.
- Your settings are kept in case you install it again. Delete `%APPDATA%\DG-Dock` to remove them too.

Needs: Windows 11 (64-bit) and the Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime, which comes with Windows 11. If it's missing, DG-Dock tells you where to get it.

Meet the dock

The dock is split into rounded pills. From left to right: the Start button and your apps, your folders and the Recycle Bin, then the widgets.



1. **Start button** — left-click for Search, right-click for the Windows Start menu.
2. **Pinned apps** — click to open; click again to minimise.
3. **Running dot** — a small dot under an app that's open.
4. **Page dots** — show which page of apps you're on.
5. **Folders** — point at one to see what's inside.
6. **Recycle Bin** — right-click to empty it.
7. **Clock** — click for calendar and notifications.
8. **Battery and Wi-Fi** — scroll for brightness, click for Quick Settings.
9. **Now playing** — cover art and sound wave; scroll for volume.
10. **System tray** — your system-tray apps.
11. **Show desktop** — click to see the desktop.

Moving it around

Right-click an empty part of the dock (or open **Settings › Look › Position**) to put it at the **bottom**, **left** or **right** of the screen. Everything works the same on the sides — cards open sideways instead of upwards.

Turn on **Show on all displays** and the dock follows your mouse to whichever screen you're using.

Tip: The dock's colour matches the Windows taskbar. Change Windows between light and dark mode (or turn on “Show accent colour on Start and taskbar”) and the dock changes with it.

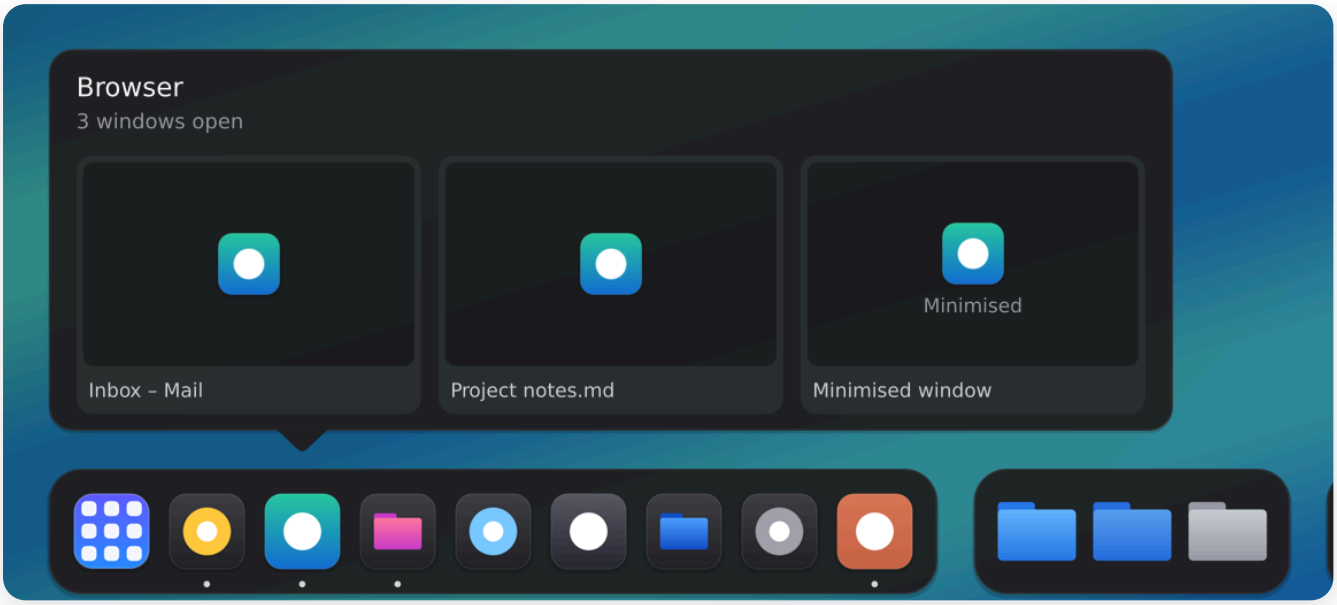


The dock on the right-hand side.

04 · EVERYDAY USE

Opening and switching apps

The dock works the way you'd expect — and a few extra clicks and scrolls make switching between windows quicker.



Point at an open app to see a live preview of each of its windows.

Clicking

- **Click** an app to open it, or bring it to the front if it's already open.
- **Click again** when it's in front to minimise it.
- **Middle-click** (or Ctrl + click) to open a new window.
- Opening an app makes its icon **bounce** until it's ready.

Window previews

- Point at an open app: a card shows each window, live.
- Click a preview to go to that window.
- Point at a preview and click its **×** to close it.

Scrolling on an app

- **Scroll up** on an open app to bring its windows forward one by one.
- **Scroll down** to minimise them.

Right-click menu

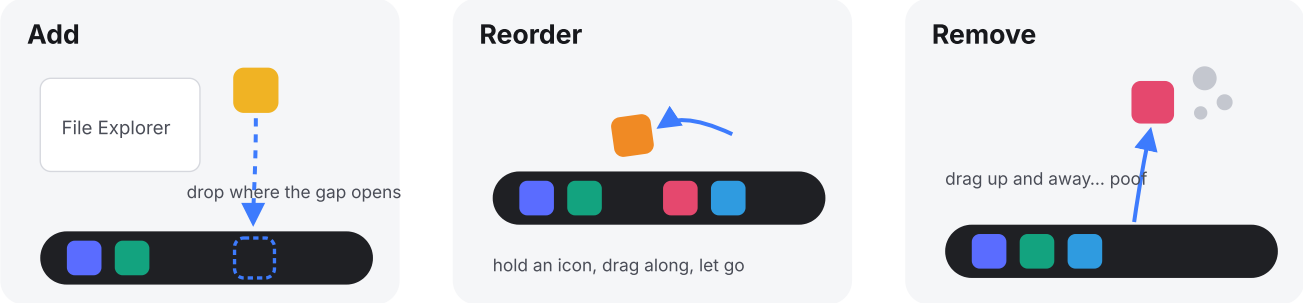
- See and switch between all the app's windows.
- **New window**, **Show in File Explorer**.
- **Change icon** / **Reset icon**.
- **Keep in Dock** for an app you haven't pinned, or **Remove from Dock**.
- **Close window** / **Close all windows**.

Magnification: icons grow smoothly as you move along the dock and a label shows the app's name. If you prefer gentler movement, lower the **animation speed** in Settings (section 11).

05 · MAKE IT YOURS

Arranging your dock

Add, move and remove things right on the dock by dragging — or use **Edit Dock** in Settings for exact control.



On the dock

- **Add:** drag an app, file or folder from File Explorer, the desktop or Start on to the dock. A gap opens where it will go.
- **Reorder:** press and hold an icon, slide it along, let go.
- **Remove:** drag the icon up off the dock until it shows a puff, then let go.
- **Keep an open app:** drag an app from the open-apps pill into your pinned apps, or right-click › **Keep in Dock**.
- Right-click empty space › **Add folder...** or **Add program or file...**

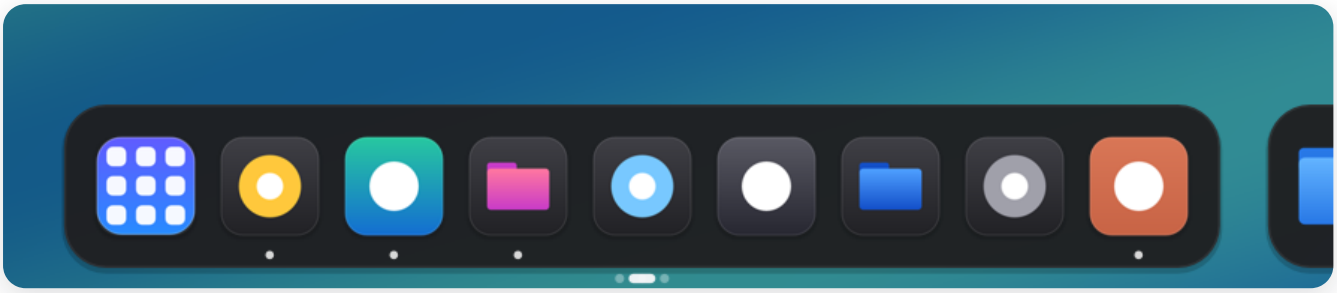
Edit Dock (in Settings)

- Open Settings and click the **pencil** at the bottom.
- Every item has a **number**. Click it and type a new position.
- Or hold the ⋮⋮ **grip** and drag the row.
- Headings show which items are on page 1 and page 2.
- Buttons on each row: change icon, reset icon, remove.
- **Add apps...** lists every installed app with a search box.

06 · LOTS OF APPS

Pages and the open-apps pill

When you have more apps than fit on one row, DG-Dock splits them into two pages. Apps you haven't pinned get a pill of their own.



The page dots under the apps pill. The wide dot is the page you're on.

Pages

- Set how many apps go on a page with the **Apps per page** slider in Settings (or type a number, or “All”).
- **Scroll** (up/down, or sideways on a touchpad) over the apps pill to flip page.
- Apps slide across in the direction you scroll, and the dock grows or shrinks to fit — no empty gaps.
- There are never more than two pages: if you add more apps, each page holds more.

The open-apps pill

- Open an app that isn't pinned and a new pill **splits off** beside your folders, then the app slides in.
- More open apps slide in one after another.
- Apps pinned on the page you're *not* looking at also show here while they're open, so you can always reach them.
- Close the last one and the pill **melts back** into the dock.
- Turn this off with **Open apps** in Settings.

How the pill splits off



1 · A small pill buds off



2 · It grows, carrying the app

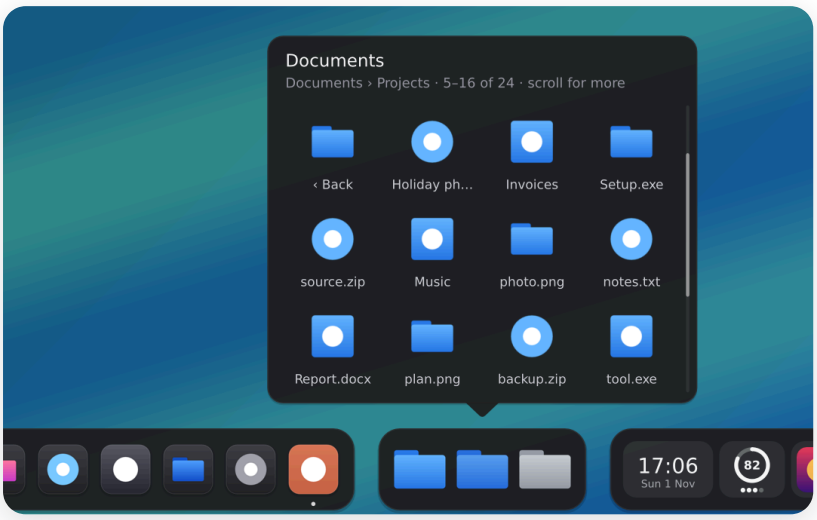


3 · The app is in its own pill

07 · FILES

Folders

Any folder on the dock opens as a card. Browse inside it without opening File Explorer.



In a folder card

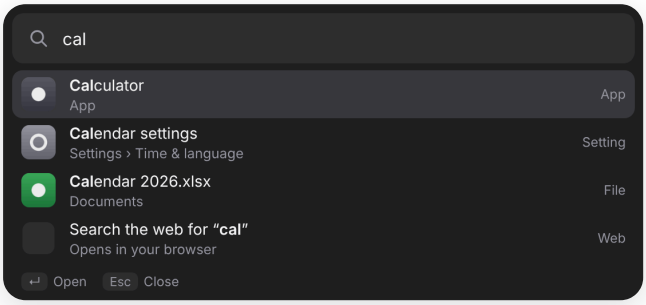
- **Point** at a folder to open its card. Newest items come first.
- **Click a file** to open it.
- **Click a folder** to open it inside the card. **‹ Back** takes you up again.
- **Scroll** to see more; the bar on the right shows where you are.
- **Right-click** a folder to open it in File Explorer, or a file to show it in its folder.
- **Shift + right-click** a tile to change its icon.
- Click the card's title area to open the folder you're looking at.

Add any folder: drag it on to the dock, or right-click empty space › **Add folder...**. Documents and Downloads are there to start with. With an icon pack (section 12), the folders and files inside cards use the pack's icons too.

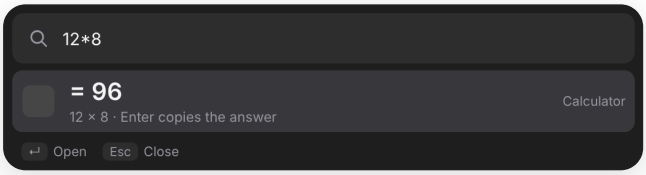
08 · FIND ANYTHING

Search and the Start button

A Spotlight-style search that pops out of the Start button — styled to match your dock.



Results for "cal": an app, a Windows setting, a file and a web search.



Type a sum and the answer appears straight away.

Opening Search

- **Click the Start button** on the dock.
- Or press `Alt` + `Space` anywhere (`Ctrl` + `Alt` + `Space` if another app already uses Alt + Space).
- **Right-click the Start button** to open the normal Windows Start menu instead.

What it finds

- **Apps** — everything installed, matched by name, first letters ("vsc" → Visual Studio Code) and near-misses.
- **Settings** — jump straight to Windows settings pages.
- **Files** — recent files and your Desktop, Documents and Downloads.
- **Sums** — e.g. `12*8`, `(3+4)^2`, `2^10 / 4`.
- **The web** — if nothing matches, search the web in your browser.

Keys

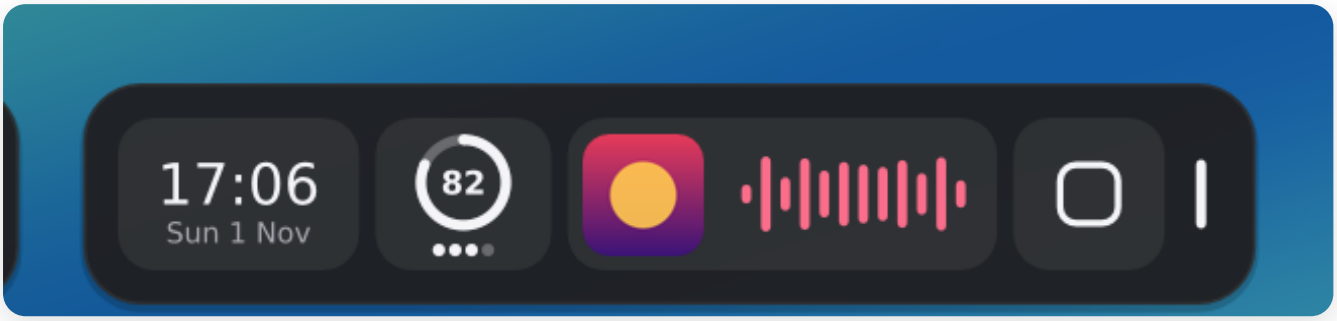
`↑` `↓` / `Tab`	Move through results
`Enter`	Open (copies the answer for sums)
`Ctrl` + `Enter`	Show a file in its folder
`Esc`	Clear the box, or close Search

Apps you open often move up the list. Prefer the Windows Start menu on left-click? Turn off **Start button opens Search** in Settings.

09 · AT A GLANCE

Widgets

The pill on the right shows the time, your battery and Wi-Fi, and what's playing — and each one does something when you click or scroll on it.



Clock

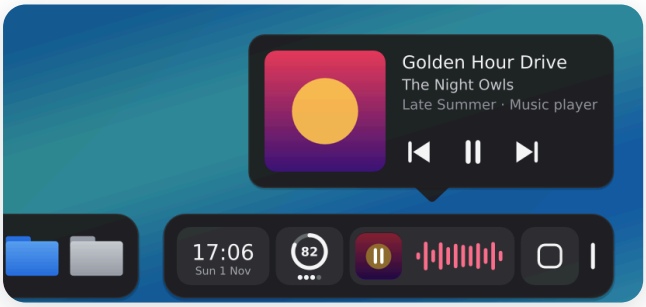
- Time and date (12- or 24-hour, following Windows).
- **Click** for Windows' calendar and notifications.

Battery and Wi-Fi

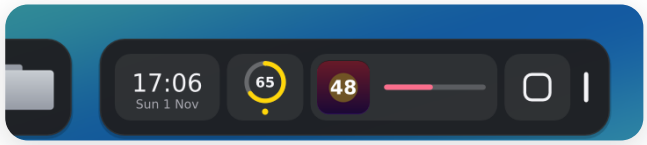
- The ring shows battery left; it turns green when charging.
- The dots underneath show Wi-Fi strength.
- **Scroll** on it to change **screen brightness** — the ring turns yellow while you do.
- **Click** for Windows Quick Settings.

Now playing

- Cover art from Spotify, YouTube Music or any player.
- A **sound wave** in the cover's colours slides out while music plays and tucks away when you pause.
- **Click** to play or pause; **point** at it for previous / next.
- **Scroll** on it to change **volume**.



Point at Now playing for the track and controls.



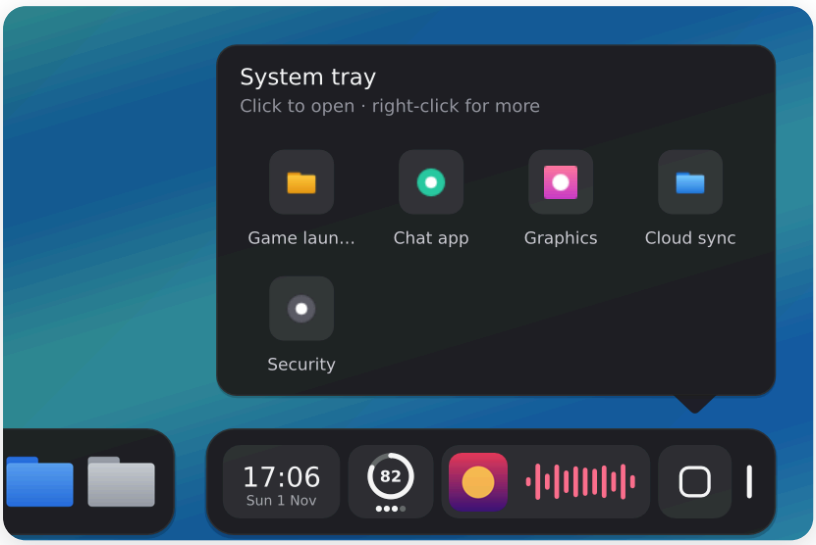
Scrolling: brightness shows on the ring, volume on the player.

Tip: Turn all widgets on or off with **Widgets** in Settings.

10 · NO TASKBAR NEEDED

System tray and Show desktop

The apps that normally sit in the corner of the Windows taskbar — chat apps, game launchers, cloud storage, security — live in one tile at the end of the dock.



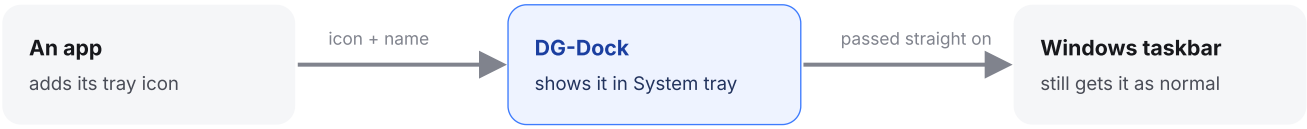
System tray

- **Point** at the rounded-square tile to see all your tray apps.
- **Click** an app to open it, just like in the taskbar.
- **Right-click** an app for **Open**, the app's own menu, **Change icon...** and **Quit**.
- **Quit** closes the app properly; if it only hides itself, DG-Dock offers to force it to quit.
- **Right-click the tile** itself to change any tray app's icon.
- With an icon pack, tray apps use the pack's icons automatically.

Show desktop

- The slim bar at the very end of the dock.
- **Click** to minimise everything; **click again** to bring it all back.

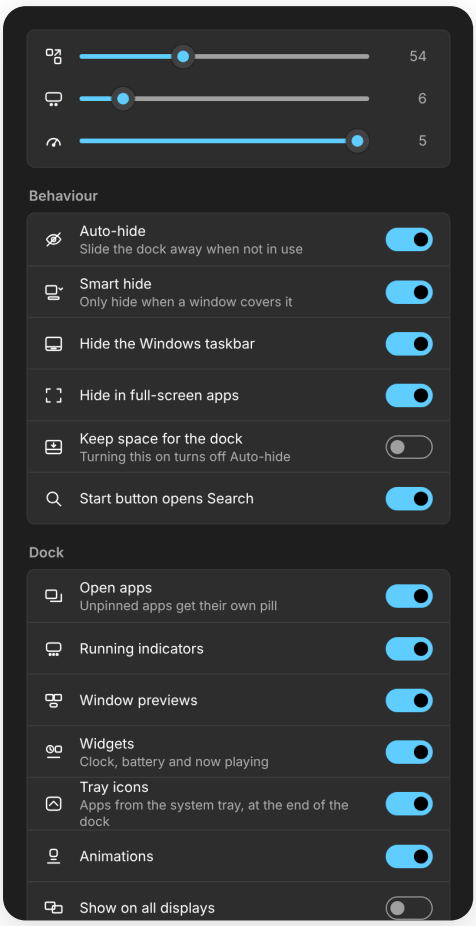
How tray icons reach the dock



Windows' own battery and volume icons are left out, because the dock's widgets already show them. If a tray app ever misbehaves, turn off **System tray** in Settings — everything goes back to the taskbar straight away.

Settings

Right-click empty space on the dock › **Dock settings**. The panel slides out of the dock and closes when you click away.



Sliders — drag or type

Icon size	How big the icons are (32–96).
Apps per page	4–20, or “All” for a single page.
Animation speed	1 (slowest) to 5 (normal). Slows every animation: magnification, cards, pages, bounces, panels.

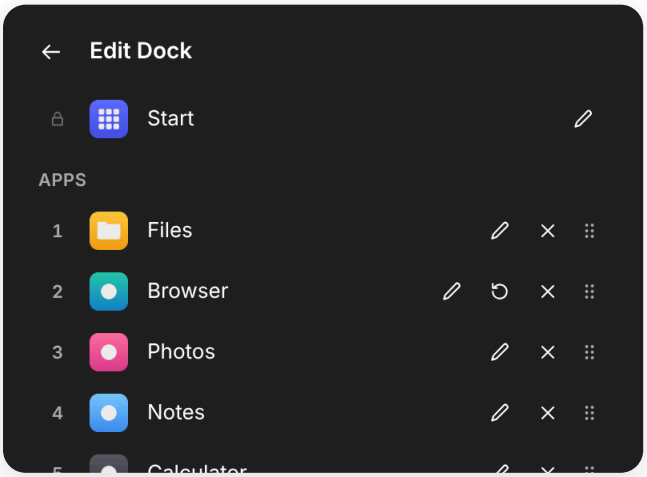
Typing a value: click the number next to a slider, type, press `Enter`. `↑` `↓` nudge it, `Esc` cancels. Values outside the range are brought back in.

Switches

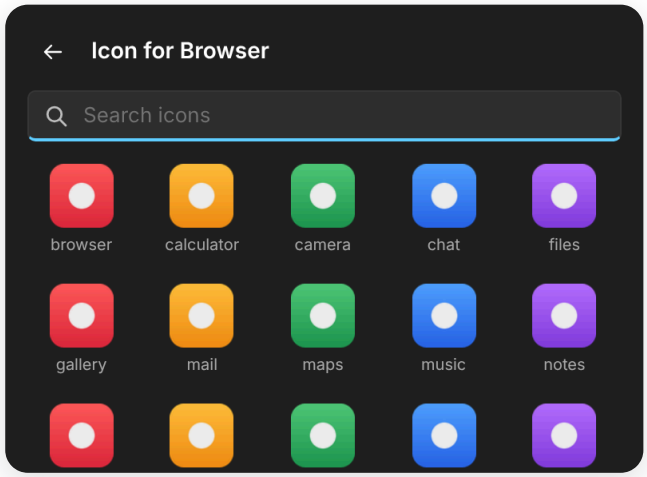
Behaviour	Auto-hide · Smart hide · Hide the Windows taskbar · Hide in full-screen apps · Keep space for the dock · Start button opens Search
Dock	Open apps · Running indicators · Window previews · Widgets · System tray · Animations · Show on all displays
Look	Position · Appearance (Match Windows, Light, Dark) · Icon style (Rounded tiles or Original) · Icon pack
System	Start with Windows

Bottom bar

DG-Dock 1.0.0 opens About (version, licence, open-source notices) · ♥ supports development · **pencil** opens Edit Dock · **power** quits DG-Dock (the taskbar comes back).



Edit Dock: numbers to type a position, grips to drag.



The icon picker, with your icon pack's icons.

12 · STYLE

Icons and icon packs

Give the whole dock a matching look with an Android icon pack, or change single icons by hand.

Using an icon pack

1
Get a pack
Any Android icon pack you own, as an **.apk** file.

→

2
Import it
Settings › Look › **Icon pack** › **Import an Android icon pack (.apk)...**

→

3
Done
Matching icons are swapped in everywhere straight away.

DG-Dock matches icons by name, so *Steam* gets the pack's Steam icon. It applies the pack to:

- Apps and folders on the dock
- Files and folders inside folder cards (plain folders get the pack's folder icon)
- Apps in the tray card
- Anything without a match keeps its normal icon

Changing one icon

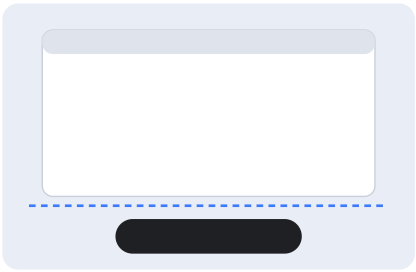
WHAT	HOW
App or folder on the dock	Right-click it › **Change icon**, or the pencil in Edit Dock
Tray app	Right-click it in the tray card › **Change icon...**, or right-click the tray tile
File or folder in a folder card	**Shift** + right-click it › **Change icon...**

The picker opens with the name already searched. Click an icon to use it, **Choose from a file...** to use your own picture (.png, .ico, .jpg, or an .exe/.dll's icon), or **Use original** to undo.

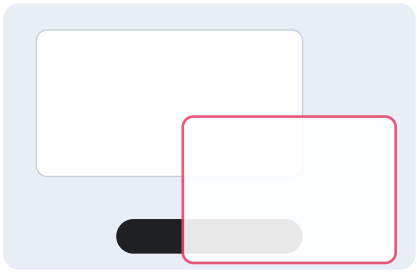
Icon style: “Rounded tiles” puts every app icon on a matching rounded tile like the rest of the dock; “Original icons” shows them as they are.

Hiding and screen space

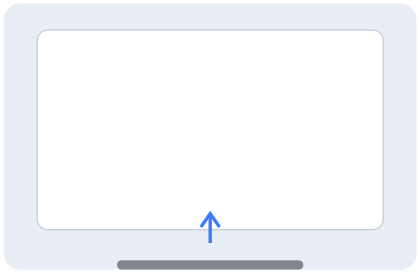
Choose whether the dock always shows, steps aside for your windows, or stays tucked away until you need it.



Keep space for the dock
Maximised windows stop above it, with a small gap.



Smart hide
Hides only when a window covers it; comes back when the window moves.



Auto-hide
Slides away; push the mouse to the screen edge to bring it back.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Auto-hide	The dock slides off the screen when you're not using it. Move the mouse to that edge to bring it back.
Smart hide	With Auto-hide on: the dock only hides when a window actually overlaps it.
Keep space for the dock	Maximised windows stop just above the dock instead of going under it. Use this *or* Auto-hide: turning one on turns the other off.
Hide the Windows taskbar	Hides the normal taskbar while DG-Dock is running. It comes back when you quit or uninstall.
Hide in full-screen apps	Games, videos and presentations get the whole screen.
Show on all displays	With more than one monitor, the dock moves to the screen your mouse is on. Turn it off to keep the dock on your main display.
Appearance	Match Windows (follows light/dark mode and the taskbar colour), Light or Dark.

Quick toggles: right-click empty space on the dock for **Automatically hide the Dock**, **Hide the Windows taskbar** and **Position on screen** without opening Settings.

Cheat sheet

DO THIS	TO
Click an app	Open it / bring it forward / minimise it if it's in front
Middle-click or Ctrl + click an app	Open a new window
Scroll up / down on an open app	Bring its windows forward / minimise them
Point at an open app	Live window previews
Drag on / along / off the dock	Add / reorder / remove
Scroll over the apps pill	Flip between pages
Point at a folder	Folder card; click folders to go inside
Right-click / Shift + right-click in a folder card	Open in File Explorer / change the icon
Click Start · `Alt` **+** `Space`	Search
Right-click Start	Windows Start menu
Click the clock	Calendar and notifications
Click / scroll the battery ring	Quick Settings / screen brightness
Click / scroll Now playing	Play–pause / volume
Point at / right-click the tray tile	Tray apps / change tray icons
Click the bar at the end	Show desktop (click again to restore)
Right-click empty space	Dock menu: Search, hiding, position, add items, settings, quit

Troubleshooting

Most problems have a one-click fix.

IF...	TRY THIS
Windows says “Windows protected your PC”	Click **More info › Run anyway**. This shows for new, unsigned programs.
Your antivirus blocks the installer	Restore the file from quarantine and allow it, or download it again from the official page. Please report it so it can be submitted as a false alarm.
Search or Settings won't open	Install the free Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime from microsoft.com/edge/webview2.
A tray app doesn't respond	Turn **System tray** off in Settings — the app goes back to the taskbar.
Alt + Space doesn't open Search	Another app uses it; DG-Dock then uses `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `Space`. The dock menu shows which.
The taskbar is still hidden after quitting	Start DG-Dock and quit it from Settings (power button), or turn off “Automatically hide the taskbar” in Windows Settings › Personalisation › Taskbar.
Everything feels too fast	Lower **Animation speed** in Settings.

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